

Sample Prompt

Please enter your name

Anupriya

Ok

Exit

Figure 6: Prompt

alerts. Here is the explanation.

Under the body tag, there is a list of alerts in the form of links and these will call respective methods when clicked.

1 and 2: On clicking 'Show Alert' the method `showAlert()` will be called, which will call the 'notification,alert' method and an alert box will pop up with the 'Battery Low' message; this will call the 'alertDismissed' callback, when 'OK' is clicked in the alert box. The output for an alert message is displayed in Figure 4.

3 and 4: On clicking 'Show Confirm' the method `showConfirm()` will be called with a 'Do you want to continue?' message. On clicking *Continue* or *Exit* it will take you to 'onConfirm', and an alert will pop up which will return the selected button index. The output for confirm dialogue box is displayed in Figure 5.

5 and 6: On clicking 'Show Prompt' the method `showPrompt()` will be called with an edit text box, where the user needs to provide an input. Then 'onPrompt' will be called as a callback, and will return whatever the user entered with a welcome message. The output for the prompt box is displayed in Figure 6.

7. On clicking 'Play Beep', the device will beep twice with the device's default beep sound.

8. On clicking 'Vibrate' the device will vibrate for 5 seconds.



Figure 7: Splashscreen



Note: The Play Beep and Vibrate methods should be tested on the device to observe the results.

SplashScreen

This shows you how to give your application an image for the starting screen, which will be shown when your application is still loading at the back end.

Usage: It is used in apps where the application needs some time to load. During that time the image will replace the blank screen with a nice picture to give users a better experience.

The methods for using this API are:

1. `navigator.splashscreen.show();` To show the splashscreen.
2. `navigator.splashscreen.hide();` To hide the splashscreen.

Pre-requisite: Put your splash screen image into the `res/drawable` folder of the Android project. The recommended sizes for each image are:

- `xlarge (xhdpi)`: at least 960 x 720 pixel.
- `large (hdpi)`: at least 640 x 480 pixel
- `medium (mdpi)`: at least 470 x 320 pixel
- `small (ldpi)`: at least 426 x 320 pixel

Now add the following code in the `MainActivity.java`:

```
super.setIntegerProperty("splashscreen", R.drawable.splashscreen);
```

This will take the image from `R.drawable.splashscreen` (where `splashscreen` is the name of the image), which will be added to the application.

```
super.loadUrl("file:///android_asset/www/splashscreen.html",20000);
```

There is one more parameter in `loadUrl` '20000', which defines how many seconds the splashscreen will be displayed.

```
//SplashScreen.html
document.addEventListener("deviceready", onDeviceReady, false);
```

```
function onDeviceReady() {
    navigator.splashscreen.show();
}
```

Similarly, `hide()` can be used to hide the screen.

Though we have covered some more APIs in this article, this is not the end. PhoneGap provides many more APIs, which you can easily explore, as all of them use a similar kind of format. There are many more plugins that can be used with PhoneGap to enhance its benefits. So try your hand at playing with plugins too. Keep exploring and learning. The doors for help are always open. 

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